Isabelle "Izzy" Sunby

Contact Information

Department of Government, Harvard University
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LinkedIn

Education

Harvard University *PhD Student* 2026-*Present*
Subfields: International Relations, Comparative Politics, Methods

University of Wisconsin-Madison *Bachelor of Science with Distinction* 2022-2026
Political Science, *Comprehensive Honors*
Spanish, *Comprehensive Honors*
Certificate, Chinese Professional Communication
Certificate, Statistics

CIEE Advanced Liberal Arts Program in Seville, Spain Spring 2024
Universidad de Sevilla, Facultad de Filologia

Research Interests

Authoritarianism, Political Economy, International Norms, East Asia, Latin America

Languages

English	Native Proficiency
Spanish	Full Professional Proficiency
Mandarin Chinese	Professional Working Proficiency

Research Projects & Independent Work

Senior Honors Thesis under Dr. Jon Pevehouse 2025-2026
"Advancing Authoritarianism: Stability Outcomes of Chinese Foreign Aid in Latin America"
Department of Political Science, University of Wisconsin- Madison

Sophomore Research Fellowship under Dr. Tana Johnson 2024-2025
"Autocracies & International Diplomatic Cooperation: Collaboration and UN Engagement by Latin American Authoritarian Regimes"
Department of Political Science & LaFollette School of Public Affairs,
University of Wisconsin- Madison

Research Experience

Research Project Assistant for Dr. Tana Johnson Sept. 2023- *Present*
Department of Political Science, University of Wisconsin- Madison

Supported Dr. Johnson's research on intergovernmental institutions and international public policy through literature compilation, data collection and analysis, draft paper editing, and policy memo development.

Research Assistant for Dr. Karl Rohe May 2025-Jan 2026
Department of Statistics, University of Wisconsin- Madison

Collaborated with other students in Rohe Labs to conduct and facilitate research on large language model efficacy and data extraction processes in academic data reporting.

Presentations & Conferences

Midwest Political Science Association Conference April 2026
Undergraduate Poster Presentation,
"Advancing Authoritarianism: Outcomes of Chinese Foreign Aid"

UW-Madison Undergraduate Research Symposium — April 2026
Undergraduate Poster Presentation,
"Advancing Authoritarianism: Outcomes of Chinese Foreign Aid"

Midwest Political Science Association Conference — April 2025
Undergraduate Poster Presentation,
"Autocracies & International Diplomatic Cooperation"

UW-Madison Undergraduate Research Symposium — April 2025
Undergraduate Poster Presentation,
"Autocracies & International Diplomatic Cooperation"

Selected Awards & Fellowships

Honorable Mention — June 2026
Diversity, Equity, Justice & Power Best Undergraduate Paper Award
UW-Madison Department of Political Science

Commencement Flag Bearer — May 2026
College of Letters and Science, UW-Madison

Hilldale Undergraduate/Faculty Research Fellowship — April 2025
Awarded for Senior Honors Thesis Project
Undergraduate Academic Awards, UW-Madison

Honorable Mention, Legal Committee — February 2025
Harvard National Model United Nations

Sophomore Research Fellowship — April 2024
Awarded for Independent Student/Faculty Research Project
Undergraduate Academic Awards, UW-Madison

Kurz & Directors Fund Study Abroad Award — November 2023
College of Letters and Science Honors Program, UW-Madison

Study Abroad Scholars — October 2023
Study Abroad Program, UW-Madison

William F. Vilas Scholarship — October 2023
College of Letters and Science, UW-Madison

Academic Excellence Scholarship — 2022-2026
State of Wisconsin Higher Educational Aids Board

Kemper K. Knapp National Merit Scholarship — 2022-2026
Undergraduate Academic Awards, UW-Madison

Bruce A. Bogue Scholarship — 2022-2026
Undergraduate Academic Awards, UW-Madison

Dean's List — 2022-2026
College of Letters and Science, UW-Madison

Leadership & Volunteer Experience

Vice President, Wisconsin Model United Nations Team — 2024-2025

Single-handedly created and organized a Model United Nations training program for undergraduate students. Collaborated with other leaders to manage team affairs, finances, educational programming, and travel. Promoted discussions of global policy solutions and facilitated cooperation between diverse viewpoints.

General Volunteer Staff, Wisconsin High School Model United Nations 2024-2025

Volunteered to staff and facilitate our Madison-based Model UN Conference serving high school students across the state of Wisconsin and the broader Midwest region. Provided simulation support for discussions of nuclear energy production.

Admissions Volunteer, Office of Admissions & Recruitment Sept 2025 - Jan 2026

Volunteered as a panelist for UW-Madison prospective student events. Represented the university and provided relevant information to address attendee's concerns.

Additional Work Experience

Front Desk Assistant, Office of the Dean of Letters & Science May 2025- *Present*

Greeted visitors and contributed to everyday operations to support the office of Dean Eric Wilcots, serve the campus community, and facilitate administrative communications. Actively contributed to the Course Learning Outcomes expedited process to improve the clarity of course goals in the College of Letters & Sciences.

Senior Sales Associate, Mulligal LLC 2020-2023

Independently managed the storefront, solved transaction challenges, and engaged with customers. Organized and created product information and inventory data.

Professional Affiliations

General Member, Pi Sigma Alpha Sept 2025- *Present*

General member of the Pi Chapter of PSA National Political Science Honor Society. Members are required to exhibit high achievement in advanced Political Science coursework and maintain a minimum GPA of 3.5.

Member, Midwest Political Science Association December 2024- *Present*

Skills

Technical: RStudio & RMarkdown, Qualtrics, LaTeX
Quantitative: Applied regression analysis, econometric analysis, data visualization, game-theoretic modeling
Languages: Spanish (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Working Proficiency)
Other: Public speaking, curriculum planning, leadership, teaching

(Updated 06/2026)